PROJECT ARA

The American Renewal Agenda

A governing framework anyone can adopt: scored, sourced, costed, and written into draft bills.

Fix the Foundations · Same Rules for Everyone · Build What Lasts

112	16	640	12
scored proposals	draft bills	sources	first-term priorities

What it is. A thirty-year plan for healthcare, education, and infrastructure, built the way the most effective political roadmaps are built: every proposal scored on the evidence, tied to a bill, placed in a sequence, and paid for in a published ledger. It is free to use. No permission, fee, or membership is asked of anyone who runs on it.

The first-term Core Agenda

1. Clean up Congress. Ends trading on nonpublic information and sets one standard for officials — the trust every other reform depends on.

2. Free, simple tax filing. Puts free direct filing and pre-filled returns into law, so no administration can switch them off.

3. Health costs now. Restores the premium credits that lapsed at the end of 2025, makes rural health funding permanent, and ends surprise ambulance bills — with the credits paid for by ending Medicare Advantage overbilling.

4. Childcare families can afford. Caps childcare costs at 7% of income for households up to about three times the poverty line, and funds new slots.

5. Fair prices, fair credit. All-in prices with no hidden fees, the 36% rate cap that already protects servicemembers, and medical debt off credit reports.

6. Social Security solvency. Applies the payroll tax to earnings above $250,000 before the late-2032 shortfall, closing 57% of the long-range gap while protecting every current benefit.

7. A floor that keeps pace. Indexes the wage floor and benefit thresholds, and delivers recession relief by formula instead of negotiation.

8. Homes people can afford. More homes legal to build, faster permits, and limits on large investors buying existing homes.

9. A fair shot at a first contract. Workers who vote to organize can reach a first contract through mediation and arbitration.

10. Build it here. Firm clean power, transmission, and domestic chips and batteries, paid by milestone with recapture.

11. Checks on every President. National emergencies expire unless Congress approves them, impoundment law is enforced, and Insurrection Act triggers are defined.

12. Second chances. Automatic sealing of old records and wider earned-time credits, so people who served their sentence can work.

Each has support across party lines or a bipartisan record, and drafted text ready for the first Congress of a term.

How it is paid for

About **$1.5 trillion** added to deficits over ten years, interest included (likely range $1.1 trillion to $1.9 trillion), against **$4.1 trillion** for the 2025 tax law by the Congressional Budget Office's count.

- No income-tax rate rises for anyone earning under $400,000.
- Paid leave pays for itself; ending Medicare overbilling pays for the health coverage bridge; later family programs may spend only what their revenue brings in.
- Social Security is financed separately: the payroll tax on earnings above $250,000 closes about 57% of its long-range gap.

What it is not

- Not legislation ready to introduce: 325 amounts, rates, and dates in the bills are left for legislative counsel and the Congressional Budget Office.
- Not an official score. The fiscal model is published so anyone can rerun and challenge it.
- Not an organization to join. Adopt all of it, the Core, one pillar, or a single proposal.

Read it, share it, adapt it. Disagree with it in public if you disagree. Authored by the Reform Democrats of the New Commonwealth; published for public adoption by the American Renewal Initiative; written by a human author with AI assistance, disclosed in the document.